

THEATRE

Stories to Tell

Aasakta Kalamanch Theatre, based in Pune, has emerged as a vibrant theatre community. Here are four popular plays, directed by Mohit Takalkar, being presented in Bangalore.



◀ **Garbo (Marathi)** Written by playwright Mahesh Elkunchwar, *Garbo* is a play that deals with shattered dreams and the reality of mediocrity bound by inhibitions. *Garbo* talks about young people who defy conventions. It stars Nachiket Poornapatre, Sarang Sathaye, Omkar Govardhan, Radhika Apte. At Ranga Shankara, on August 15.

Bed Ke Neeche Rehne Wali (Hindi) Adapted from a children's play by Duncan Wells, it is about young Ira and her invisible friend. Ira grows up and stops believing in her invisible friend's existence. The play dwells on the friend seeking answers as to why Ira stopped believing. It stars Alok Rajvade, Poornapatre, Mrinmayi Godbole and Parna Pethe. At Ranga Shankara, on August 16.



◀ **Tu (Marathi)** Written by playwright Sateer, the play unfolds through 52 poems written by Rumi. The abstract play juxtaposes imagery with the immortal lyricism of Rumi to create a story of a man, woman, king, beggar and storyteller. The cast includes Poornapatre, Govardhan, Apte, Ashish Mehta and Sathaye. At Ranga Shankara, on August 15.



▲ **Legitimate Hooley (English)** Written by Badley Hayward, the play deals with 15 nights in the life of a modern urban couple. In a lighter vein, the performance examines age-old concepts that have haunted couples over generations. Should men be forced to go shopping? Does love really exist and other such existential questions. The cast includes Sagar Deshmukh and Apte. At Kyra Theatre, on August 13. **by Nirmala Ravindran**

IF YOU HAVE 90 MINUTES, listen to monsoon-inspired classical music at the ICCR Malhaar festival from August 17-19 at the Kamani Auditorium, Delhi.

FILM FESTIVAL

Show TIME

Anil Zankar, film academic and filmmaker, in collaboration with NCPA, has put together a lecture on Indian Cinema: Thematic Presentation. 'Youth' is the current theme at NCPA, Mumbai, and Zankar has chosen three films which showcase issues concerning youth across decades. Gulzar's *Mere Apne* (1971), Nagesh Kukunoor's *Hyderabad Blues* (1998) and Sudhir Mishra's *Hazaron Khwaishein Aisi* (2003) are to be screened. From August 12 to 14, at Godrej Dance Academy Theatre, Mumbai.

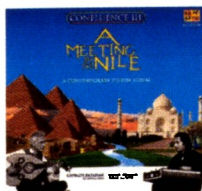
by Pankti Mehta

A SCENE FROM HAZARON KHWAISHEIN AISI



MUSIC REVIEW

Fusion Fare



A MEETING BY THE NILE
Saregama Rs 299

between two cultures. Kazazian plays the Egyptian instrument, the Oud, while Sharma plays the santoor and both have pushed their musical boundaries to create a wonderful

After his collaboration with Richard Clayderman, Rahul Sharma joins forces with the Egyptian maestro Georges Kazazian on yet another journey

fusion. Some numbers bear the essence of film music from the 1970s. Sunidhi Chauhan lends her voice on *Marhaba Jaanam*. Kazazian has created exciting tones and textures by using a variety of ethnic instruments including the Egyptian Kanoun, Dumbak and other kinds of percussion. *Meeting by the Nile*, sung by Sharma, is a perfect example of lounge-like music. In *Taj Mahal*, both have tried to recreate the grandeur of the monument through their tunes. *Nights in Cairo* captures the night life of Cairo with peppy beats oft heard in discotheques. All songs have been written and composed by Sharma. Here's to music building cultural bridges. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**